

SHAHIDH SALIHEEN

Urban Planning Undergraduate

Urban Planner | GIS & Spatial Analyst | Research & Data Analysis

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📍 Colombo, Sri Lanka

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year undergraduate in BSc (Hons) in Urban Informatics and Planning at the University of Moratuwa, having successfully completed all academic requirements and currently awaiting final results. Experienced in supporting multidisciplinary projects through research, GIS and spatial analysis, project coordination, technical reporting, and data-driven assessments. Skilled in stakeholder engagement, field-based data collection, project documentation, and analytical problem-solving across academic and industry projects. Experienced in applying spatial technologies, managing project workflows, and translating complex data into actionable insights to support planning and decision-making processes. Adaptable and detail-oriented, with strong interests in urban development, GIS, research, project management, and evidence-based solutions across diverse professional environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Intern – Research & Business Development - Global GIS (Pvt) Ltd

Apr - Dec 2025

- Supported GIS, land development, infrastructure, and municipal projects through spatial analysis, field surveys, drone-based data collection, and technical reporting.
- Conducted land-use, accessibility, terrain, and suitability assessments to support site feasibility studies, planning evaluations, and development decision-making.
- Coordinated project datasets, survey outputs, maps, and analytical deliverables across GIS, survey, and planning teams, ensuring timely completion of project milestones.
- Assisted in the preparation of technical reports, maps, presentations, and project documentation for public- and private-sector clients.
- Processed and interpreted spatial datasets, including GNSS, LiDAR, photogrammetry, and drone survey outputs, to generate planning and development insights.
- Supported proposal development, competitor analysis, and client presentations by contributing technical content and spatial evidence.
- Utilized ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, AutoCAD Civil 3D, Pix4D, and 3D Survey to deliver project outputs within multidisciplinary project environments.

Part-Time Architectural Assistant – AIDA Design Studio

Apr – Oct 2025

- Assisted in the preparation of architectural drawings, spatial layouts, and 3D models for residential and commercial development projects.
- Developed design visualizations using AutoCAD, SketchUp, and Enscape to support concept development and client communication.
- Supported design refinement and revisions based on planning considerations, site constraints, and client requirements.
- Coordinated with architects during design development stages to ensure consistency between planning objectives and architectural outcomes.

Freelance Designer – Commercial Land Development Project

Jan 2023

- Supported planning and visualization of an 8-acre commercial land development project.
- Prepared site layouts, AutoCAD plans, and SketchUp massing models.
- Assisted in identifying suitable spatial arrangements to maximize accessibility and commercial functionality.

Freelance Transcriber (Tamil to English)

Oct 2023 & Nov 2024

- Transcribed Tamil audio recordings into English, ensuring accuracy and cultural context for clear understanding.
- Completed projects efficiently and met client specifications, enhancing skills in bilingual transcription and translation.
- Skills: Transcription, translation, language proficiency (Tamil & English), attention to detail.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) in Urban Informatics and Planning

2022 – Present

University of Moratuwa

- CGPA: 3.81
- Dean's List: L1S1, L1S2, L2S3, L3S5, L4S7

Additional Certifications

Foundations of Project Management

2025

- University of Moratuwa (Online)

Project Scope and Schedule Management

2026

- University of Moratuwa (Online)

PROJECTS

INDUSTRY PROJECTS

Drone & Site Survey Projects – Trincomalee, Colombo MC & Ramba Archaeological Site

(Global GIS Pvt Ltd)

- Conducted drone-based, GNSS-supported, and photogrammetric surveys to support land development, municipal planning, infrastructure, and heritage-related projects.
- Processed LiDAR and drone survey data to generate orthomosaics, contour maps, terrain models, and 3D surface models for planning and development assessments.
- Produced GIS-based maps, spatial datasets, and analytical outputs to support site feasibility studies, development planning, and decision-making processes.
- Collaborated with GIS, survey, and planning teams to deliver project reports and technical outputs.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Individually Supervised Site Planning and Design Project

Jan 2026 – May 2026

– REVITALIZING PETTAH: Activating Heritage Through a Structured Market Spine

- Developed a heritage-led urban regeneration proposal for the Old Town Hall and Market Precinct in Pettah, integrating heritage conservation, informal economy management, and multimodal mobility.
- Conducted spatial analysis of pedestrian movement, conflict zones, and future development pressures to inform planning and design decisions.
- Prepared urban design proposals including public realm improvements, adaptive reuse strategies, and a pedestrian-oriented market spine to enhance accessibility, place identity, and urban vitality.
- Produced masterplans, 3D models, visualization renders, and urban design guidelines to communicate proposed interventions and future development scenarios.
- Developed phased implementation strategies, financial feasibility assessments, and PPP-based funding mechanisms to support long-term project delivery.

Individually Supervised Research Project (ISRP) – Night-Time

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

Food Culture Developments, Colombo

- Conducted spatial, social, and economic analysis of night-time food activity nodes to understand emerging urban dynamics and informal economic systems.
- Collected and analyzed primary data through surveys, stakeholder interactions, and field observations to assess user behavior, accessibility, and operational patterns.
- Applied spatial analytical techniques including Logistic Regression, GWR, and SCCM to identify location patterns, clustering behavior, and growth drivers.
- Produced maps, visualizations, and evidence-based recommendations to support planning and management of night-time urban activities.

Heritage Development Planning – Nuwara Eliya

Jan - March 2025

- Developed a heritage-sensitive planning proposal balancing conservation priorities with urban development needs in Nuwara Eliya.
- Applied GIS-based spatial analysis and Multi-Criteria Decision Making (MCDM) techniques to identify conservation-sensitive areas and development opportunity zones.
- Formulated planning and design guidelines to support controlled development while preserving the town's heritage character and cultural significance.
- Produced spatial plans, suitability assessments, and development recommendations to support sustainable heritage management.

Traffic Analysis using YOLO Object Detection

Jan 2025

- Developed a YOLO object detection model to automate vehicle detection, classification, and traffic counting from video footage.
- Integrated traffic observations into an SQL database for data management and longitudinal analysis.
- Applied R-based visualization and dashboarding techniques to analyse traffic patterns and support evidence-based transport planning.

Regional Planning Project – Human–Elephant Conflict (HEC), Sri Lanka

Sep – Oct 2024

- Conducted spatial and socio-economic analysis of conflict patterns using land-use, environmental, and livelihood data.
- Reviewed the National Physical Planning Policy (NPP) and assessed planning responses to HEC.
- Proposed revised zoning, settlement strategies, and development control measures.
- Prepared livability and conflict-risk maps and evaluated development projects.
- Recommended alternative interventions aligned with ecological sustainability and human safety.

Local Plan – Trincomalee Municipal Council Area

Jan – Mar 2024

- Prepared a development-oriented local plan focusing on tourism-led economic growth, public space enhancement, and community-oriented development.
- Conducted land-use analysis and accessibility assessment to identify suitable zones for leisure, commercial, and public activities.
- Proposed spatial strategies to support long-term urban vitality and local economic activation.

Urban Design & Residential Planning Proposal – Badulupitiya, Badulla

Aug – Sep 2023

- Developed a compact residential planning and design proposal emphasizing efficient land subdivision, walkability, and integration of public and green spaces.
- Applied density, accessibility, and livability principles to optimize land use and enhance residential quality of life.
- Proposed spatial strategies to support long-term urban vitality and detail design proposal.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Research & Analysis

- Research Design & Data Collection
- Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis
- Spatial Analysis & Interpretation
- Data Visualization
- Technical Report Writing
- Evidence-Based Decision Making

Project & Coordination

- Project Coordination & Documentation
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Cross-functional Collaboration
- Project Monitoring & Reporting
- Workflow & Timeline Management
- Presentation Development

GIS & Planning

- GIS Mapping & Spatial Analysis
- Remote Sensing Applications
- Land Use & Accessibility Analysis
- Site Suitability Assessment
- Urban & Regional Planning
- Development Planning & Policy Analysis

Leadership & Professional Skills

- Analytical Problem Solving
- Communication & Presentation
- Adaptability & Continuous Learning
- Teamwork & Leadership
- Attention to Detail
- Professional Conduct

EXPERTISE

- **Productivity Tools:** Microsoft Word, PowerPoint, Excel, Nvivo
- **Collaboration & Documentation Tools:** Microsoft SharePoint, Google Documents, Canva
- **GIS & Spatial Analysis :** QGIS, ArcMap, ArcGIS Pro, AutoCAD, AutoCAD Civil 3D, SketchUp,GEE
- **Technical & Surveying Tools:** GNSS/GPS, 3D Survey, PIX4D, LiDAR data processing
- **Data Analysis & Statistics:** R, Python (basic), SPSS, Microsoft Excel

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Associate Member** – Institute of Town Planners Sri Lanka

Present
- **Batch Representative** - Semester 8 T&CP 21st Batch

2026
- **Batch Representative** - Majlis-Ul-Islam, University of Moratuwa

2026
- **Translator** – Town & Country Planning Students’ Society

2024 - 2025
- **Football Player** - Team Captain (School)

2014 - 2015

LANGUAGES

Tamil: **Native**

Sinhala: **Proficient**

English: **Proficient**

REFERENCES

Dr. Rizvi Noordeen (PhD, UK)

- Senior Lecturer, Head of the Department
- Department of Town & Country Planning,
University of Moratuwa
- Tel : +94 77 220 2336
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Plnr.Y. Arthy

- Assistant Director (Town Planning)
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